ANCHOR CHURCH

DISCOVER MORE

Discovery 1

Week 2: Grow in Groups

All scripture is from the New Living Translation unless noted otherwise.

GROW IN GROUPS

ANCHOR CHURCH'S MISSION STATEMENT

We exist to help people pursue Jesus in every area of their lives.

THE FOUR WAYS WE HELP YOU PURSUE JESUS

- Experience God (Week 1)
- **Grow in Groups** (Week 2)
- Discover Purpose (Week 3)
- Go Make a Difference (Week 3, Discovery 2)

YOU GROW IN SMALLER GROUPS

Week 1 was about you starting to pursue Jesus and to start experiencing God. Because God created us for community experiencing God and growing in groups go hand-in-hand. A natural result of experiencing God is a desire to be with God's people. This happened at the very inception of the Church in Acts 2 when they experienced the power of the Holy Spirit.

> Acts 2:42–47
> 42 All the believers devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching, and to fellowship, and to sharing in meals (including the Lord's Supper), and to prayer.
> 43 A deep sense of awe came over them all, and the apostles performed many miraculous signs and wonders. 44 And all the believers met together in one place and shared everything they had. 45 They sold their property and possessions and shared the money with those in need. 46 They worshiped together at the Temple each day, met in homes for the Lord's Supper, and shared their meals with great joy and generosity—47 all the while praising God and enjoying the goodwill of all the people. And each day the Lord added to their fellowship those who were being saved.

The early church experienced God in a powerful way, and as a result starting meeting. They naturally went to the temple (church service) and met in homes (small groups).

We want to mimic what the early church did, with services on the weekend and small groups, called Connect Groups, during the week.

WHAT CONNECT GROUPS DO

The old saying is "you are who you hang out with," and as you hang out with God's people who are dedicated to be like Jesus, the natural result is that you will start to become like Jesus as well. Being a part of a Connect Group promotes growth by giving you:

1. A place to belong.

   Acts 2:46–47
   46…shared their meals with great joy and generosity—47 all the while praising God and enjoying the goodwill of all the people.

2. Encouragement.

   Hebrews 10:24–25
   24 Let us think of ways to motivate one another to acts of love and good works. 25 And let us not neglect our meeting together, as some people do, but encourage one another, especially now that the day of his return is drawing near.

   Proverbs 27:17
   17 As iron sharpens iron, so a friend sharpens a friend.

3. Healing.

   James 5:16 (NLT)
   16 Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The earnest prayer of a righteous person has great power and produces wonderful results.

NEXT STEPS:

- Join a Connect Group. Talk to a Discover More team member to help you pick the right one. Go to myanchor.church/get-connected to find a group.
- Take the Personality and Spiritual Gifts Surveys at discovermore.app.
- Attend Discovery 1 Week 3 next week.

QUESTIONS:

- Why is being in a group and having community vital to growing in your faith in Jesus?
- Of the three things that Connect Groups give (a place to belong, encouragement, healing) what stuck out to you and why?
- Do you have any fears or apprehensions about joining a Connect Group? If so share with the group.
- What can help you get over those fears or apprehensions?